

GRADE 12 ENGLISH

EUEE MASTER STUDY GUIDE

Ethiopian University Entrance Exam

Complete Exam Preparation · All 10 Units

Grammar · Reading · Vocabulary · Writing

Listening Strategies · Speaking Skills

Simplified · Exam-Focused · High-Score Strategies

Based on the Federal Democratic Republic of Ethiopia

Ministry of Education — Grade 12 English Student Textbook

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

This guide covers every topic in your Grade 12 English textbook, simplified and organised so you can study smarter — not harder. It focuses on the language skills, grammar rules, vocabulary, and writing techniques most frequently tested on the Ethiopian University Entrance Exam (EUEE). Here is what each box means:

EXAM FOCUS

Must-know content — these topics appear in almost every EUEE English paper.

COMMON MISTAKES

The errors that cost students marks every single year. Avoid them.

PRO TIP

Smart shortcuts and memory tricks to remember difficult rules quickly.

KEY DEFINITION

Crucial terms and rules — clearly highlighted for fast recall.

QUICK REVISION

Compact summaries you can review in the final week before the exam.

NEXT LEVEL LEARNING

Slightly advanced ideas that go beyond the textbook to spark deeper understanding.

Read the explanations first, then attempt the practice questions. If you score below 70% on a section, return to it the next day. Repetition with active recall is the single most powerful study habit for the EUEE.

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EUEE ENGLISH EXAM OVERVIEW

The EUEE English paper is a multiple-choice exam designed to measure how well you use English for university-level reading, writing and reasoning. Although the exact number of questions can vary slightly, the structure has remained stable for years.

What the EUEE English Paper Tests

- Reading Comprehension — usually 2 to 4 passages with 4–8 questions each.
- Vocabulary in Context — synonyms, antonyms, word meaning from context.
- Grammar & Structure — tense, voice, conditionals, relative clauses, reported speech, etc.
- Sentence Correction — fragments, run-ons, faulty parallelism, agreement errors.
- Cohesion & Discourse — choosing the correct linker (however, therefore, although...).
- Verbal Reasoning — analogies, sequencing, true/false/not given.

EXAM FOCUS — High-Yield Areas

1. Reading comprehension (the largest single section)
2. Conditionals (zero, first, second, third, mixed)
3. Active and passive voice
4. Reported (indirect) speech
5. Relative clauses (who, whom, whose, which, that)
6. Linking words (cause, result, contrast, comparison)
7. Subject-verb agreement
8. Synonyms / antonyms / vocabulary in context

PRO TIP — Time Management

Spend roughly 1 minute per question. For reading passages, scan the questions FIRST, then read the passage with those questions in mind. This single habit can raise your score by 10–15 marks.

UNIT 1 — SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT

Theme vocabulary: development, conservation, biodiversity, innovation, sustainability, infrastructure.

1.1 Key Reading Skills

- Skimming — read quickly to find the MAIN idea of a text.
- Scanning — read quickly to find a SPECIFIC detail (a name, date, or number).
- Reordering incidents — putting events back into the correct sequence.
- Connecting text with real life — relating ideas to your own experience.

KEY DEFINITION — Sustainable Development

Development that meets the needs of the present without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs.

1.2 Vocabulary in Focus

demise — death; the end of something

stakeholder — a person with an interest or concern in something

unconventional — not based on what is generally done; original

stagnate — to stop developing; become inactive or dull

prototype — the first model of something from which others are developed

biodiversity — the variety of plant and animal life in a place

conservation — protection of nature and natural resources

mobilize — to organise people or resources for a purpose

1.3 Grammar — Comparing and Contrasting

These cohesive devices link sentences and ideas. They are tested very frequently in EUEE cloze and sentence-completion questions.

Words showing similarity (Compare):

similarly, likewise, in the same way, like, as...as, just as, both...and, in comparison to, similar to.

Words showing difference (Contrast):

however, but, yet, although, even though, though, whereas, while, on the other hand, in contrast, unlike, despite, in spite of.

KEY DEFINITION — Although vs Despite

Although + clause: Although it was raining, we went out.

Despite + noun/-ing: Despite the rain, we went out.

NEVER write: 'Despite it was raining...' — that is wrong.

COMMON MISTAKES

- × Using 'but' AND 'although' in the same clause: 'Although she was tired, but she studied.'
- ✓ Correct: 'Although she was tired, she studied.' OR 'She was tired, but she studied.'
- × 'In contrast of' ✓ 'In contrast to' / 'In contrast with'
- × 'Same with' to mean 'similar to' ✓ 'The same as' / 'Similar to'

PRO TIP — One-Word Memory Trick

BUT, YET, AND → join two equal clauses (FANBOYS).

ALTHOUGH, EVEN THOUGH, WHEREAS → start a subordinate clause; need a main clause too.

HOWEVER, IN CONTRAST, ON THE OTHER HAND → start a NEW sentence; use a semicolon or full stop, then a comma.

1.4 Writing — Comparison & Contrast Paragraph

Two organisation patterns are tested:

- Block method: describe Topic A fully, then Topic B fully.
- Point-by-point: compare A and B feature by feature.

A good comparison paragraph has: a topic sentence, supporting examples, linking words, and a concluding sentence.

1.5 Sentence Fragments

A fragment is an INCOMPLETE sentence — it is missing a subject, a verb, or a complete thought.

- Fragment: Because I was late. → Complete: Because I was late, I missed the bus.
- Fragment: Running down the road. → Complete: She was running down the road.

QUICK REVISION — Unit 1

- Skim for main idea; scan for details.
- 'Although' joins clauses; 'Despite' uses a noun/-ing form.
- 'However' begins a new sentence; 'but' joins inside one.
- Every sentence needs a subject, a verb, and a complete idea.

1.6 EUEE-Style Practice

1. ____ the heavy rain, the farmers worked all day. (a) Although (b) Despite (c) However (d) But
2. Choose the fragment: (a) She studies hard. (b) Because she wants to pass. (c) She wants to pass the EUEE. (d) Studying is important.
3. Antonym of 'sustainable': (a) lasting (b) renewable (c) temporary (d) reliable
4. Synonym of 'mobilize': (a) freeze (b) organize (c) ignore (d) waste

Answers: 1-b, 2-b, 3-c, 4-b

UNIT 2 — TIME MANAGEMENT

2.1 Vocabulary — Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal verbs are tested in almost every EUEE paper. They behave in three grammatical patterns:

KEY DEFINITION — Three Types of Phrasal Verbs

1. Verb + Adverb (separable, with object): 'put on a hat' / 'put a hat on'.
Examples: bring up, fill in, find out, look up, put away, take off, turn off.
2. Verb + Adverb (no object, inseparable): 'I get up at 7'.
Examples: break down, check in, get up, set off, show up.
3. Verb + Adverb + Preposition (object, inseparable): 'look forward to'.
Examples: come up with, do away with, run out of, look up to, face up to.

Common high-frequency phrasal verbs:

call off — cancel

carry out — perform / complete

come across — find by chance

get over — recover from

give up — stop trying

look after — take care of

put off — postpone

turn down — refuse / lower volume

run out of — have no more left

look forward to — anticipate happily

2.2 Grammar — Result Clauses

Result clauses tell us WHAT HAPPENED because of something. They are joined with linking words such as so, therefore, consequently, as a result, so...that, such...that.

KEY DEFINITION — so / such

- so + adjective/adverb + that: It was so cold that the lake froze.
- such + (a/an) + adjective + noun + that: It was such a cold day that the lake froze.
- Cause connectors: because, since, as, for, due to, owing to.
- Result connectors: so, therefore, hence, thus, as a result, consequently.

COMMON MISTAKES

- × She is so a good student. ✓ She is such a good student.
- × Due to he was late, he missed it. ✓ Because he was late, he missed it.

('Due to' is followed by a noun: 'Due to his lateness, he missed it.')

× The reason is because... ✓ The reason is that...

2.3 Reading — Topic Sentences and Main Ideas

- The topic sentence is usually the FIRST sentence of a paragraph.
- Supporting sentences add details, examples and evidence.
- The concluding sentence restates or wraps up the main idea.

PRO TIP — Finding the Main Idea Fast

Read only the FIRST and LAST sentence of each paragraph. Then ask: 'What is the writer trying to prove?' That single answer is usually the correct option in main-idea questions.

2.4 EUEE-Style Practice

5. Please don't ___ the meeting again. (a) put off (b) put on (c) put away (d) put up
6. It was ___ a difficult question that nobody could answer it. (a) so (b) such (c) very (d) too
7. He failed the exam ___ he didn't study. (a) so (b) because (c) but (d) although
8. He ran out ___ time during the test. (a) of (b) with (c) for (d) at

Answers: 1-a, 2-b, 3-b, 4-a

QUICK REVISION — Unit 2

- Phrasal verbs: learn meaning + whether they take an object.
- 'So + adj + that' / 'Such + (a/an) + adj + noun + that'.
- 'Because' + clause; 'Because of / Due to' + noun.
- Topic sentence usually leads the paragraph.

UNIT 3 — EVIDENCE ON TRAFFIC ACCIDENT

3.1 Grammar — Conditional Sentences

This is one of the MOST tested topics in EUEE English. Master the four types.

Type	If-clause	Main clause	Use
Zero	If + present simple	present simple	facts / scientific truths
First	If + present simple	will / can / may + base	real future possibility
Second	If + past simple (were)	would / could / might + base	unreal / imagined present
Third	If + past perfect	would / could / might have + V3	imagined past (regret)

Examples (memorise these):

- Zero: If you heat ice, it melts.
- First: If it rains tomorrow, we will stay home.
- Second: If I were you, I would wear a helmet. (advice / unreal)
- Third: If he had worn a seatbelt, he would not have died. (past regret)
- Mixed: If I had studied medicine, I would be a doctor now. (past condition → present result)

EXAM FOCUS — Conditionals

EUEE often tests:

- Spotting the wrong tense in a conditional sentence.
- Choosing 'were' (not 'was') in the second conditional.
- Recognising mixed conditionals (3rd → 2nd) used for present regret about a past action.

COMMON MISTAKES

- × If I will see her, I will tell her. ✓ If I see her, I will tell her.
- × If I was you, I would study. ✓ If I were you, I would study.
- × If I would have known, I would have come. ✓ If I had known, I would have come.
- × He wouldn't have failed unless he didn't study. ✓ He wouldn't have failed if he had studied.

PRO TIP — The 'Backshift' Rule

For each step into 'unreality', shift the tense ONE step back: present → past, past → past perfect. Practise 5 examples a day for one week and conditionals will never trick you again.

3.2 Writing — Narrative Essay

A narrative essay tells a story. It typically uses past tenses (simple, continuous, perfect) and time linkers (first, then, after that, suddenly, finally).

- Setting → Characters → Conflict → Climax → Resolution.
- Use vivid verbs and adjectives; show, don't just tell.
- Keep the narrator (1st or 3rd person) consistent throughout.

3.3 Vocabulary in Context (Traffic & Safety)

reckless — showing lack of care for danger

vulnerable — easily harmed or hurt

hazardous — dangerous; risky

rampant — spreading uncontrollably

preventable — able to be stopped from happening

severe — very bad or serious

disproportional — too large or too small relative to something

3.4 EUEE-Style Practice

9. If she ___ harder, she would have passed. (a) studied (b) had studied (c) studies (d) would study
10. If I ___ you, I would apologise. (a) am (b) was (c) were (d) be
11. Antonym of 'reckless': (a) careful (b) wild (c) brave (d) hasty
12. Choose the second-conditional sentence: (a) If it rains, we'll stay. (b) If I won the lottery, I'd buy a house. (c) If he had called, I would have come. (d) If you heat water, it boils.

Answers: 1-b, 2-c, 3-a, 4-b

QUICK REVISION — Unit 3

- 4 types of conditionals: zero, first, second, third (+ mixed).
- Use 'were' for ALL persons in second conditional.
- Narrative essay: past tenses + time markers.
- Vocabulary of risk: reckless, hazardous, severe, vulnerable.

UNIT 4 — NATURAL RESOURCE MANAGEMENT

4.1 Grammar — Adverbial Clauses of Time

These clauses tell WHEN something happens. They are introduced by time conjunctions and are tested heavily in cloze and error-spotting questions.

KEY DEFINITION — Time Conjunctions

when, while, as, before, after, until, till, since, as soon as, by the time, once.

Rule: After a time conjunction referring to the FUTURE, use the PRESENT tense — not 'will'.

Example: I will call you when I arrive (NOT 'when I will arrive').

Quick patterns:

- While + past continuous, simple past: While I was reading, the phone rang.
- As soon as + present (future meaning), will + V: As soon as he comes, we'll start.
- Since + past time, present perfect: I have lived here since 2018.
- By the time + present, future perfect: By the time you arrive, I will have finished.

COMMON MISTAKES

- × I will tell you when she will come. ✓ I will tell you when she comes.
- × I have seen him since two years. ✓ I have known him for two years. / since 2022.
- × Until I will finish, I won't go. ✓ Until I finish, I won't go.

4.2 Reading — Inference Questions

Inference questions ask: What can be inferred? What does the writer suggest? The answer is NOT directly stated — you must read between the lines.

- Eliminate options that are too extreme (always, never).
- Eliminate options that contradict the passage.
- Choose the option supported by evidence in two or more sentences.

4.3 Vocabulary — Environment Theme

deforestation — clearing of forests on a large scale

erosion — wearing away of soil or rock by water/wind

renewable — able to be replaced naturally (solar, wind)

depletion — reduction in number or quantity

habitat — the natural home of a plant or animal

ecosystem — community of organisms and their environment

preserve — to keep something in its original state

scarcity — shortage of something

4.4 EUEE-Style Practice

13. I will wait here ___ you return. (a) until (b) since (c) for (d) by
14. She has been studying ___ three hours. (a) since (b) for (c) from (d) at
15. Synonym of 'scarcity': (a) abundance (b) shortage (c) plenty (d) excess
16. ___ the storm started, we ran inside. (a) Until (b) As soon as (c) By the time (d) Since

Answers: 1-a, 2-b, 3-b, 4-b

QUICK REVISION — Unit 4

- After time conjunctions referring to future, use PRESENT tense.
- 'Since' + point in time; 'For' + duration.
- Inference = NOT directly stated; supported by clues.
- Environment vocabulary: ecosystem, habitat, depletion, scarcity.

UNIT 5 — MECHANIZED AGRICULTURE

5.1 Grammar — Verbals (Gerunds, Infinitives, Participles)

Verbals are forms made from verbs but used as other parts of speech. EUEE asks you to identify them and pick the right one to follow specific verbs.

KEY DEFINITION — Three Verbals

1. GERUND (-ing form, used as a NOUN): 'Reading is fun.'
2. INFINITIVE (to + base, used as noun/adjective/adverb): 'I want to read.'
3. PARTICIPLE (-ing or -ed, used as ADJECTIVE): 'A crying baby.' 'A broken plate.'

Verbs followed by GERUND only:

enjoy, avoid, finish, mind, suggest, deny, admit, consider, postpone, practice, can't help, keep, miss, recommend, risk.

Verbs followed by INFINITIVE only:

want, hope, plan, decide, agree, refuse, promise, expect, manage, offer, fail, pretend, choose, learn.

Verbs followed by EITHER (with same meaning):

begin, start, continue, like, love, hate, prefer.

Verbs followed by EITHER (with different meaning):

- stop doing = no longer do something / stop to do = pause in order to do.
- remember doing = recall the past act / remember to do = not forget a future act.
- try doing = experiment / try to do = attempt with effort.

PRO TIP — A Memory Trick

Imagine these verbs as 'thinkers' (decide, hope, plan, refuse) — they look forward, so they take TO + verb. Verbs of 'enjoyment, avoidance, completion' (enjoy, avoid, finish) describe an experience already happening — so they take -ING.

COMMON MISTAKES

- × I enjoy to swim. ✓ I enjoy swimming.
- × I want swimming. ✓ I want to swim.
- × She suggested to go home. ✓ She suggested going home.
- × He avoided to meet me. ✓ He avoided meeting me.

5.2 Participles as Adjectives (-ing vs -ed)

- -ing describes the cause: 'a boring lecture' (it causes boredom).
- -ed describes the feeling: 'I am bored' (I feel boredom).
- Common pairs: interesting/interested, exciting/excited, tiring/tired, confusing/confused, surprising/surprised.

5.3 EUEE-Style Practice

17. He avoided ___ me at the party. (a) to meet (b) meeting (c) meet (d) met

18. I'd love ___ to Hawassa next year. (a) going (b) to go (c) go (d) gone
19. The film was very ___. I felt really ___. (a) bored / boring (b) boring / bored (c) bore / bored (d) boring / boring
20. She suggested ___ a new restaurant. (a) to try (b) try (c) trying (d) tried
Answers: 1-b, 2-b, 3-b, 4-c

QUICK REVISION — Unit 5

- Gerund = verb-ing acting as noun.
- Infinitive = to + base.
- Memorise verb lists (enjoy, avoid, finish → -ing; want, hope, plan → to-V).
- -ING describes the source; -ED describes the feeling.

UNIT 6 — GREEN ECONOMIES

6.1 Grammar — Relative Pronouns and Clauses

KEY DEFINITION — The Relative Pronouns

who → people (subject): The man who called you is here.
whom → people (object): The man whom I met is a doctor.
whose → possession: The girl whose bag was stolen is crying.
which → things / animals: The book which I read was great.
that → people, things, animals (defining clauses only).
where → places. when → times. why → reasons.

6.2 Defining vs Non-Defining Clauses

- Defining (no commas): The student who studies hard succeeds. (essential information)
- Non-defining (with commas): My brother, who lives in Addis, is a doctor. (extra info)
- 'That' CANNOT be used in non-defining clauses.

COMMON MISTAKES

× The book who I read was great. ✓ The book which/that I read was great.
× The girl which lives next door is kind. ✓ The girl who lives next door is kind.
× My father, that lives in Addis, is a doctor. ✓ My father, who lives in Addis, is a doctor.
× The reason why he came is because... ✓ The reason why he came is that...

6.3 Writing — Faulty Parallelism

Parallelism = items in a list use the SAME grammatical form. EUEE often tests this.

- Wrong: She likes swimming, to read, and hike.
- Right: She likes swimming, reading, and hiking.
- Right: She likes to swim, to read, and to hike.

PRO TIP — The Parallelism Test

Whenever you see 'and', 'or', 'but' connecting a list, check that all items are the same kind: all -ing forms, all to-infinitives, all nouns, or all clauses. If one is different, the sentence is wrong.

6.4 Vocabulary — Economy Theme

sustainable — able to be maintained at a certain rate

emission — release of gas, especially into the air

renewable — naturally replenishable energy

incentive — a reward that encourages action

subsidy — money given by a government to support an activity

inflation — general increase in prices

entrepreneur — person who starts and runs a business

6.5 EU EE-Style Practice

21. The teacher ___ taught me English moved abroad. (a) which (b) whose (c) who (d) where

22. This is the village ___ I was born. (a) which (b) where (c) who (d) when

23. Choose the parallel sentence: (a) She is smart, kind, and works hard. (b) She is smart, kind, and hardworking. (c) She is smart, kindness, and hardworking. (d) She has smarts, kindness, and works hard.

24. Synonym of 'incentive': (a) penalty (b) motivation (c) burden (d) tax

Answers: 1-c, 2-b, 3-b, 4-b

QUICK REVISION — Unit 6

- who → people; which → things; whose → possession.
- Defining clauses: NO commas; 'that' allowed.
- Non-defining clauses: WITH commas; 'that' NOT allowed.
- Parallelism: keep all items in a list the same form.

UNIT 7 — NATIONAL PRIDE

7.1 Grammar — Direct & Indirect (Reported) Speech

When we report someone's words, we usually 'shift back' the tense by one step and change pronouns and time markers.

DIRECT SPEECH	REPORTED SPEECH
Present simple	Past simple
Present continuous	Past continuous
Present perfect	Past perfect
Past simple	Past perfect
will	would
can	could
may / must	might / had to

Time and place changes:

- now → then; today → that day; yesterday → the day before / the previous day
- tomorrow → the next day / the following day; last week → the week before
- this → that; these → those; here → there

Reporting questions:

- Yes/No questions → use 'if' or 'whether': 'Are you tired?' → He asked if I was tired.
- Wh- questions → keep the question word, no inversion: 'Where do you live?' → She asked where I lived.
- Commands → 'told/asked + object + to + verb': 'Sit down.' → He told me to sit down.

COMMON MISTAKES

- × He said me that he was tired. ✓ He told me that he was tired. (say + that; tell + person + that)
- × She asked where do I live. ✓ She asked where I live(d). (no question word order in indirect)
- × He said he will come. ✓ He said he would come.

PRO TIP — When NOT to Backshift

If the reported fact is still TRUE, you can keep the present tense:
She said the earth is round. (still true → no backshift needed)
But if you are unsure, backshifting is always grammatically safe.

7.2 Phrasal Verbs (Unit 7)

run out of — have no more

cut down on — reduce

carry on — continue

keep away from — avoid contact with

get along with — have a good relationship

put up with — tolerate

look back on — remember the past

look forward to — wait excitedly

7.3 EUEE-Style Practice

25. He said, 'I am tired.' → He said that he ___ tired. (a) is (b) was (c) were (d) had been

26. She asked, 'Where do you live?' → She asked where ___. (a) do I live (b) I live (c) lived I (d) I lived

27. He said, 'I will help you tomorrow.' → He said he ___ help me ___. (a) will / tomorrow (b) would / the next day (c) would / tomorrow (d) will / the next day

28. I can't ___ his rude behaviour any longer. (a) put up with (b) put off (c) put on (d) put away

Answers: 1-b, 2-d, 3-b, 4-a

QUICK REVISION — Unit 7

- Backshift one tense step in reported speech.
- 'Say' has NO indirect object; 'tell' DOES need one.
- In reported questions, no inversion and no question mark.
- Time/place words shift: now→then, here→there, this→that.

UNIT 8 — TELEMEDICINE

8.1 Grammar — Active and Passive Voice

KEY DEFINITION — Active vs Passive

Active: Subject does the action. The doctor examined the patient.

Passive: The action is done to the subject. The patient was examined by the doctor.

Formula: Object → Subject + form of BE + past participle (V3) + (by + agent).

Passive forms by tense:

TENSE	PASSIVE FORM
Present simple	am / is / are + V3
Present continuous	am / is / are + being + V3
Present perfect	have / has + been + V3
Past simple	was / were + V3
Past continuous	was / were + being + V3
Past perfect	had + been + V3
Future	will + be + V3 / be going to + be + V3

When to use the passive:

- When the doer is unknown: My phone was stolen.
- When the doer is obvious: The thief was arrested. (by police)
- In formal/scientific writing: The experiment was conducted.

COMMON MISTAKES

- × The book wrote by Tolkien. ✓ The book was written by Tolkien.
- × The patient is examine now. ✓ The patient is being examined now.
- × He was stolen his phone. ✓ His phone was stolen. / He had his phone stolen.

8.2 Vocabulary — Health & Technology

diagnosis — identification of an illness

prescription — doctor's written order for medicine

symptom — sign of an illness

chronic — long-lasting (illness)

acute — severe and sudden

remote — far away; distant

consultation — meeting with a professional for advice

infectious — spreading from one person to another

8.3 Writing — Argumentative Essay

- Introduction with a clear thesis (your position).

- Body paragraphs with point + evidence + explanation.
- Counter-argument paragraph (acknowledge the other side, then refute).
- Conclusion that restates the thesis without repeating the same words.
- Useful linkers: firstly, in addition, moreover, on the contrary, however, therefore, in conclusion.

8.4 EUEE-Style Practice

29. Convert to passive: 'The nurse gives medicine.' (a) Medicine is given by the nurse. (b) Medicine gives by the nurse. (c) The nurse is given medicine. (d) Medicine was given by the nurse.
30. The bridge ___ next year. (a) will built (b) will be built (c) will be build (d) is built
31. Synonym of 'chronic': (a) sudden (b) long-term (c) mild (d) cured
32. Where would the passive be MOST appropriate? (a) Storytelling (b) Scientific reports (c) SMS messages (d) Personal diaries

Answers: 1-a, 2-b, 3-b, 4-b

QUICK REVISION — Unit 8

- Passive = form of BE + V3 (past participle).
- Use passive when doer is unknown / unimportant / formal.
- Backshift the auxiliary BE according to tense.
- Argumentative essay = thesis + arguments + counter + conclusion.

UNIT 9 — CONFLICT MANAGEMENT

9.1 Grammar — 'Wish' and 'If only'

KEY DEFINITION — Patterns with WISH

1. Wish + past simple → unreal PRESENT: I wish I were taller. (I am not tall now.)
 2. Wish + past perfect → regret about the PAST: I wish I had studied. (I didn't.)
 3. Wish + would + V → annoyance about a future/repeated act: I wish you would stop talking.
- 'If only' works the same way but expresses stronger emotion.

Examples to memorise:

- I wish I knew the answer. (I don't know now.)
- I wish I had known the answer. (I didn't know in the past.)
- I wish it would stop raining. (I want a change in behaviour.)
- If only I were rich! (Stronger than 'I wish'.)

COMMON MISTAKES

- × I wish I am rich. ✓ I wish I were rich.
× I wish I would knew. ✓ I wish I knew. / I wish I had known.
× I wish I will travel. ✓ I wish I could travel. / I hope I will travel.
Note: Use 'hope' for real future possibility, NOT 'wish'.

9.2 Subject-Verb Agreement

- Singular subject → singular verb. Plural subject → plural verb.
- Two subjects with 'and' → plural verb: Tom and Sara are here.
- 'Either...or' / 'Neither...nor' → verb agrees with the NEAREST subject.
- Indefinite pronouns (everyone, somebody, each, neither) → singular verb.
- Collective nouns (team, family, government) → singular if acting as a unit.
- Uncountable nouns (information, advice, news, money) → singular verb.

COMMON MISTAKES

- × The news are bad. ✓ The news is bad.
× Everyone are happy. ✓ Everyone is happy.
× Neither the boys nor the girl are here. ✓ Neither the boys nor the girl is here.
× One of the students are absent. ✓ One of the students is absent.

PRO TIP — The 'Trick Subjects'

Watch out for these always-singular forms: news, mathematics, physics, economics, politics, athletics, statistics (when meaning the subject), measles. They LOOK plural but take a SINGULAR verb.

9.3 EUEE-Style Practice

33. I wish I ___ the truth yesterday. (a) know (b) knew (c) had known (d) would know

34. Neither the teacher nor the students ___ here. (a) is (b) are (c) was (d) am

35. The news ___ shocking. (a) are (b) is (c) were (d) be

36. If only I ___ taller! (a) am (b) was (c) were (d) had been

Answers: 1-c, 2-b, 3-b, 4-c

QUICK REVISION — Unit 9

- Wish + past = unreal present; Wish + had-V3 = past regret; Wish + would = annoyance.
- 'Hope' for future reality; 'Wish' for unreal situations.
- Indefinite pronouns + singular verb.
- 'Either...or' / 'Neither...nor' → verb agrees with the nearest noun.

UNIT 10 — ROBOTICS

10.1 Grammar — Common Sentence Errors

KEY DEFINITION — Three Errors to Master

1. **FRAGMENT**: an incomplete sentence (missing subject, verb, or thought).
Wrong: Because she was tired. Right: She slept early because she was tired.
2. **RUN-ON**: two complete sentences joined with no punctuation.
Wrong: He ran fast he won the race. Right: He ran fast, so he won the race.
3. **COMMA SPLICE**: two complete sentences joined by ONLY a comma.
Wrong: He ran fast, he won the race. Right: He ran fast; he won the race.

Five ways to fix run-ons and comma splices:

37. Use a full stop: He ran fast. He won the race.
38. Use a semicolon: He ran fast; he won the race.
39. Use a coordinating conjunction (FANBOYS): He ran fast, so he won the race.
40. Use a subordinating conjunction: Because he ran fast, he won the race.
41. Use a transition + semicolon: He ran fast; therefore, he won the race.

PRO TIP — The FANBOYS Coordinators

For, And, Nor, But, Or, Yet, So.

Use a comma BEFORE these when joining two independent clauses.

Example: I studied hard, but I still failed.

10.2 Vocabulary — Robotics & Technology

automate — to make a process work by itself

artificial — made by humans, not natural

autonomous — able to act independently

simulate — imitate or copy something

efficient — achieving results with little waste

integrate — combine into a whole

obsolete — out of date; no longer used

innovate — introduce new ideas or methods

10.3 EUEE-Style Practice

42. Identify the fragment: (a) She studies. (b) Although she studies hard. (c) She is studying. (d) Studies help her.
43. Identify the run-on: (a) I came, I saw, I conquered. (b) I came; I saw; I conquered. (c) I came. I saw. I conquered. (d) I came, and I saw.
44. Antonym of 'obsolete': (a) outdated (b) modern (c) ancient (d) old
45. Synonym of 'autonomous': (a) dependent (b) self-governing (c) controlled (d) shared

Answers: 1-b, 2-a, 3-b, 4-b

QUICK REVISION — Unit 10

- Fragment = incomplete; needs a subject + verb + complete thought.
- Run-on = two clauses fused. Comma splice = two clauses joined by only a comma.
- Five fixes: full stop, semicolon, FANBOYS, subordinator, semicolon + transition.
- Tech vocabulary: automate, autonomous, integrate, simulate, innovate.

LAST-MINUTE REVISION GUIDE

If you only have 7 days left, use this plan. Each day = 90 minutes of focused work.

DAY 1 — Conditionals & Tenses

- Memorise the 4 types (zero, first, second, third).
- Drill 20 mixed conditional sentences.
- Review the 12 main tenses with one example each.

DAY 2 — Active vs Passive + Reported Speech

- Convert 15 active sentences to passive.
- Convert 10 direct speech sentences to indirect.
- Memorise: say + that, tell + person + that.

DAY 3 — Relative Clauses + Linkers

- Choose the right relative pronoun in 20 sentences.
- Memorise contrast/cause/result/time/comparison linkers.
- Practise punctuating defining vs non-defining clauses.

DAY 4 — Verbals + Subject-Verb Agreement

- Re-learn gerund/infinitive verb lists.
- Drill 15 agreement questions (everyone, neither...nor, news...).

DAY 5 — Vocabulary Sprint

- Review all 8 vocab boxes in this guide.
- Make flashcards for 30 words you struggle with.
- Practise 20 synonym/antonym questions.

DAY 6 — Reading Comprehension

- Practise 3 full passages under timed conditions (15 min each).
- Mark wrong answers and re-read those parts of the passage.

DAY 7 — Full Mock + Rest

- Take ONE full English mock paper, timed.
- Review mistakes calmly. Sleep at least 8 hours that night.

EUEE EXAM STRATEGY

Time Management on Exam Day

- Glance at the whole paper in the first minute. Note how many questions there are.
- Allow ~1 minute per question.
- Spend NO more than 12 minutes on any single reading passage.
- If a question stops you for more than 90 seconds, mark it and move on.
- Save the last 5 minutes for transferring answers and double-checking.

Answering Multiple-Choice Questions

- Read ALL four options before choosing.
- Use elimination — cross out clearly wrong options first.
- If two options look similar, the difference is usually the key.
- When unsure, prefer the more grammatically correct, formal-sounding option.
- Never leave a question blank — there is no negative marking.

Reading Comprehension Strategy

46. Read the questions FIRST (not the answers).

47. Skim the passage for the main idea.

48. Scan for keywords linked to each question.

49. Answer in order, easiest first.

50. For 'inference' questions, choose evidence-based options, not extreme ones.

Common Traps to Avoid

- Distractor answers that use words from the passage but change the meaning.
- Tense traps (especially in conditionals and reported speech).
- 'Always / Never / All / None' options — usually wrong in inference.
- Double negatives in questions: read them twice.
- Synonym/antonym questions — context word may not match the dictionary meaning.

PRO TIP — The 'Mark and Move' Method

For every question that takes more than 1 minute, put a small dot beside it and MOVE ON. Come back at the end. This single discipline prevents panic and saves easy marks at the back of the paper.

MOST IMPORTANT TOPICS TO REVISE

If you have very limited time, focus on these — they cover ~80% of EUEE marks.

- 1. Reading Comprehension:** Practise 1 passage every single day.
- 2. Conditionals (1st, 2nd, 3rd):** Master the tense pattern in each clause.
- 3. Active and Passive Voice:** Memorise the BE + V3 formula by tense.
- 4. Reported Speech:** Backshift one tense; change time/place words.
- 5. Relative Clauses:** who, whom, whose, which, that — defining vs non-defining.
- 6. Linking Words:** however, although, despite, because, so, therefore, similarly.
- 7. Subject-Verb Agreement:** Tricky subjects: news, everyone, neither...nor.
- 8. Verbals (Gerund vs Infinitive):** Memorise verb lists.
- 9. Vocabulary in Context:** Use surrounding words to guess unknown meanings.
- 10. Sentence Errors:** Fragment, run-on, comma splice, faulty parallelism.

NEXT LEVEL LEARNING

These ideas come from higher-level (university) English. They are NOT required for the EUEE, but they will sharpen your eye and impress markers.

1. Inversion for Emphasis

After negative or limiting expressions placed at the start, the subject and auxiliary verb are inverted.

- Never have I seen such talent.
- Hardly had I sat down when the phone rang.
- Not only did she pass, but she also won a scholarship.

2. Cleft Sentences (It-cleft and What-cleft)

- It was Almaz who solved the problem. (emphasises Almaz)
- What I really need is more time. (emphasises more time)

3. Nominalisation (Academic Style)

- Verb form: We decided to invest, and this was successful.
- Nominal form: Our decision to invest proved successful.

Academic English prefers nouns over long verb phrases. It sounds formal and concise.

4. Hedging Language for Argumentative Essays

Skilled writers avoid absolute claims. Use modals and adverbs to hedge:

- may, might, could, would, tend to, appear to, seem to, often, possibly.
- Weak: 'Smartphones are bad for students.' Better: 'Smartphones may negatively affect students' concentration in some situations.'

5. Discourse Markers Beyond 'However'

Adding sophistication: 'nonetheless, nevertheless, conversely, granted that, by the same token, in light of, with regard to, that being said'.

PRO TIP — One Rule of Excellent English

Read aloud. If a sentence sounds natural and rhythmic when spoken, it is usually well-formed. If you stumble, your reader will too.

FINAL PRACTICE TEST (EUEE-STYLE)

Time yourself: 25 minutes for 25 questions. Mark your answers, then check the answer key at the end.

PART A — Reading Comprehension

Read the passage and answer questions 1-5.

Telemedicine — the use of digital communication to deliver health care from a distance — has grown rapidly in Ethiopia over the past five years. In rural areas, where doctors are few and roads are poor, a simple video call can connect a patient to a specialist hundreds of kilometres away. While telemedicine is not a complete replacement for traditional medicine, it has already saved lives by allowing early diagnosis of conditions such as malaria, pneumonia, and chronic illnesses. Critics argue, however, that without reliable electricity and internet access, the benefits remain limited to a small portion of the population. Even so, most experts agree that investment in telemedicine infrastructure is one of the most cost-effective ways to improve national health outcomes.

51. What is the main idea of the passage? (a) Telemedicine has replaced traditional medicine. (b) Telemedicine has both benefits and limitations in Ethiopia. (c) Doctors in rural areas refuse digital tools. (d) Internet access is universal in Ethiopia.
52. What does 'cost-effective' mean in the passage? (a) very cheap (b) producing good results for the money spent (c) expensive but useful (d) free of charge
53. According to the passage, telemedicine is limited mainly because of: (a) lack of doctors (b) high cost of treatment (c) poor electricity and internet (d) cultural beliefs
54. The word 'remote' in this context most likely means: (a) controlled (b) distant (c) modern (d) familiar
55. Which sentence is best supported by the passage? (a) Telemedicine cannot save lives. (b) All Ethiopians use telemedicine. (c) Telemedicine is a useful tool but needs better infrastructure. (d) Doctors in cities oppose telemedicine.

PART B — Grammar

56. If she ___ harder, she would have passed. (a) studies (b) studied (c) had studied (d) would study
57. He ___ the report by the time you arrive. (a) will finish (b) will have finished (c) finishes (d) had finished
58. She said she ___ tired. (a) is (b) was (c) were (d) be
59. The bridge ___ in 2018. (a) built (b) was built (c) is built (d) had built
60. I'd love ___ to Lalibela. (a) going (b) to go (c) go (d) gone
61. Neither the teacher nor the students ___ the answer. (a) knows (b) know (c) was knowing (d) is knowing
62. This is the woman ___ son won the prize. (a) who (b) whom (c) whose (d) which
63. I wish I ___ a doctor. (a) am (b) was (c) were (d) be
64. She enjoys ___ on weekends. (a) read (b) reads (c) reading (d) to read
65. ___ the rain, the match continued. (a) Although (b) Despite (c) However (d) Because

PART C — Vocabulary

- 66.Synonym of 'obsolete': (a) modern (b) outdated (c) reliable (d) flexible
67.Antonym of 'scarcity': (a) shortage (b) lack (c) abundance (d) demand
68.Synonym of 'mobilize': (a) freeze (b) organise (c) ignore (d) waste
69.The doctor wrote a ___ for the medicine. (a) diagnosis (b) prescription (c) symptom (d) consultation
70.Synonym of 'incentive': (a) penalty (b) burden (c) motivation (d) refusal

PART D — Sentence Correction

- 71.Choose the FRAGMENT: (a) I went home. (b) Because I was tired. (c) I went home because I was tired. (d) Going home is a relief.
72.Choose the RUN-ON: (a) I ran. I won. (b) I ran; I won. (c) I ran I won. (d) I ran, and I won.
73.Choose the parallel sentence: (a) She likes swimming, to read, and hiking. (b) She likes swimming, reading, and hiking. (c) She likes to swim, reading, and hike. (d) She likes swims, reads, and hikes.
74.Identify the agreement error: (a) Each of the boys has a book. (b) Everyone is happy. (c) The team are winning. (d) The news are bad.
75.The correct passive: 'They built the school in 1990.' (a) The school built in 1990. (b) The school was built in 1990. (c) The school is built in 1990. (d) The school had been built in 1990.

ANSWER KEY

1-b 2-b 3-c 4-b 5-c | 6-c 7-b 8-b 9-b 10-b | 11-b 12-c 13-c 14-c 15-c | 16-b 17-c 18-b 19-b 20-c | 21-b 22-c 23-b 24-d 25-b

FINAL WORD

You now hold a complete, exam-focused review of every grammar rule, vocabulary theme, writing strategy and reading skill in Grade 12 English. The EUEE rewards consistent, active practice — not last-minute panic. Read this guide three times: once to understand, once to memorise, once to test yourself. Then walk into the exam hall calmly. You have prepared. You are ready.

Best of luck with your EUEE!

— End of Guide —